BANG FOR YOUR DUCK

# Ponoka—Didsbury

Blaine Calkins · Conservative · AB

**40 / 100**

COMPOSITE SCORE

Bang for Your Duck: D · 48/100

Value for federal tax dollars flowing into this riding

Report generated October 21, 2026

Sources: Elections Canada · OpenParliament.ca · Infrastructure Canada · Open Canada Grants & Contributions · House of Commons · StatsCan 2021

Governments publish the data. We collect it, score it, and present it in one place.

# About This Report

## Editorial Disclaimer

Bang for Your Duck is an independent, nonpartisan editorial project. Scores and grades represent opinions based on publicly available government data. This report is not legal, financial, or political advice. We are not affiliated with any political party, government body, or lobby group.

## How We Grade

This report grades your riding — not your MP personally — on measurable dollar flows: federal investment received (50%), federal transfers allocated (35%), and the cost of representation (15%). Context categories like MP Work, Electoral Health, and Demographics are shown but do not factor into the composite grade.

## What We Don't Measure

No model captures the full picture of parliamentary representation. Constituency casework, committee influence, speech quality, legislative amendments, caucus advocacy, and riding-level service delivery are important but not quantifiable from publicly available data at scale. Our scores are a starting point for conversation, not the final word.

## Structural Factors

Scores are affected by factors outside any MP's direct control: geography (travel costs are higher for remote ridings), government vs. opposition status (governing MPs have more influence over spending), provincial transfer formulas (all ridings in a province share the same transfer score), population density, and urban vs. rural characteristics. A low score reflects federal spending patterns, not an MP's dedication.

## For MPs and Staff

We grade ridings, not individuals. If any data in this report is inaccurate, we want to know. Email corrections@bangforyourduck.ca with the riding name, the data point in question, the correct figure, and supporting documentation. We review all correction requests and will update scores if warranted.

## Data Sources

- Infrastructure Canada Open Data (infrastructure.gc.ca)
- Open Canada Grants & Contributions (open.canada.ca)
- OpenParliament.ca — Session 45-1
- Elections Canada — 45th General Election
- House of Commons Proactive Disclosure (ourcommons.ca)
- Statistics Canada — 2021 Census of Population
- Department of Finance — Major Federal Transfers 2023-24

**Full methodology: bangforyourduck.ca/methodology**

# Score Breakdown

Ponoka—Didsbury · Blaine Calkins

## Federal Investment

Weight: 50%

F · 30/100 — 30

## Federal Transfers

Weight: 35%

F · 10/100 — 10

Total: $1633/person · CHT: $1155 · No equalization

## MP Expenses

Weight: 15%

D · 52/100 — 52

## MP Performance

Weight: Context

B+ · 77/100 — 77

Votes: 100% · Bills: 8 · Speeches: 500 · (+5 opposition bonus)

## Electoral Health

Weight: Context

D · 52/100 — 52

Turnout: 64.7% · Margin: 32.5% · Candidates: 6

## Demographics

Weight: Context

D · 55/100 — 55

Income: $100,200 · Unemployment: 4.7% · Post-secondary: 61%

**Grade Calculation:** (30 x 0.50) + (10 x 0.35) + (52 x 0.15) = 15 + 4 + 8 = 40/100

Grade = dollars flowing into your riding vs the cost of representation. Performance, electoral, and demographics are shown as context only.

# How Your MP Voted

Blaine Calkins · 94 of 94 votes attended · 100% participation

Vote numbers are clickable — click any # to view the full vote on OpenParliament.ca

| # | DATE | BILL | DESCRIPTION | RESULT | VOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 94 | 03-26 | — | Eighth report of the Standing Committee on | Tie | Yes |
| 93 | 03-25 | C-9 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-9, An A | Passed | No |
| 92 | 03-25 | C-9 | Bill C-9, An Act to amend the Criminal Cod | Failed | Yes |
| 91 | 03-25 | C-242 | 2nd reading of Bill C-242, An Act to amend | Failed | Yes |
| 90 | 03-25 | C-243 | 2nd reading of Bill C-243, An Act to amend | Failed | Yes |
| 89 | 03-25 | C-220 | 2nd reading of Bill C-220, An Act to amend | Failed | Yes |
| 88 | 03-25 | C-246 | 2nd reading of Bill C-246, An Act to amend | Failed | Yes |
| 87 | 03-24 | — | Opposition Motion (Tariff-free auto pact) | Failed | Yes |
| 86 | 03-23 | C-9 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-9, A | Passed | No |
| 85 | 03-11 | C-233 | 2nd reading of Bill C-233, An Act to amend | Failed | No |
| 84 | 03-10 | — | Government Business No. 6 (Proceedings on | Passed | No |
| 83 | 03-10 | — | Motion for closure | Passed | No |
| 82 | 02-25 | C-15 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-15, | Passed | No |
| 81 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | No |
| 80 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | Yes |
| 79 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | No |
| 78 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | Yes |
| 77 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | Yes |
| 76 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | No |
| 75 | 02-25 | C-15 | Bill C-15, An Act to implement certain pro | Failed | No |
| 74 | 02-25 | C-237 | 2nd reading of Bill C-237, An Act to amend | Failed | Yes |
| 73 | 02-25 | C-244 | 2nd reading of Bill C-244, An Act to amend | Passed | No |
| 72 | 02-25 | — | Opposition Motion (Federal benefits and as | Failed | Yes |
| 71 | 02-23 | — | Opposition Motion (Automotive strategy) | Failed | Yes |
| 70 | 02-23 | — | Opposition Motion (Automotive strategy ) ( | Failed | Yes |
| 69 | 02-12 | S-210 | 2nd reading of Bill S-210, An Act respecti | Passed | Yes |
| 68 | 02-12 | C-227 | 2nd reading of Bill C-227, An Act to estab | Passed | No |
| 67 | 02-12 | — | Opposition Motion (Serious crimes and refu | Failed | Yes |
| 66 | 02-09 | — | Opposition Motion (Apology to those whose | Passed | Yes |
| 65 | 02-04 | C-245 | 2nd reading of Bill C-245, An Act to amend | Failed | No |
| 64 | 02-04 | C-222 | 2nd reading of Bill C-222, An Act to amend | Passed | Yes |
| 63 | 02-04 | — | Opposition Motion (Food affordability) | Failed | Yes |
| 62 | 02-02 | C-18 | 2nd reading of Bill C-18, An Act to implem | Passed | Yes |
| 61 | 01-28 | C-228 | 2nd reading of Bill C-228, An Act to amend | Failed | No |
| 60 | 01-28 | — | Opposition Motion (Canadian economic sover | Failed | Yes |
| 59 | 12-11 | C-12 | Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu | Passed | Yes |
| 58 | 12-11 | C-12 | Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu | Passed | Yes |
| 57 | 12-11 | C-12 | Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu | Failed | No |
| 56 | 12-11 | C-12 | Bill C-12, An Act respecting certain measu | Failed | Yes |
| 55 | 12-09 | — | Opposition Motion (Pipeline construction) | Failed | Yes |

# How Your MP Voted (continued)

| # | DATE | BILL | DESCRIPTION | RESULT | VOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 54 | 12-09 | — | Opposition Motion (Pipeline construction) | Failed | Yes |
| 53 | 12-08 | C-15 | 2nd reading of Bill C-15, An Act to implem | Failed | Yes |
| 52 | 12-03 | C-241 | 2nd reading of Bill C-241, An Act to estab | Passed | Yes |
| 51 | 12-03 | C-225 | 2nd reading of Bill C-225, An Act to amend | Passed | Yes |
| 50 | 11-17 | — | Budgetary policy | Passed | No |
| 49 | 11-07 | — | Budgetary policy (amendment) | Failed | No |
| 48 | 11-06 | — | Budgetary policy (subamendment) | Failed | Yes |
| 47 | 11-05 | C-3 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-3, An A | Passed | No |
| 46 | 11-04 | — | First report of the Standing Committee on | Passed | Yes |
| 45 | 11-03 | C-3 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-3, A | Passed | No |
| 44 | 11-03 | C-3 | Bill C-3, An Act to amend the Citizenship | Passed | No |
| 43 | 10-28 | — | Third report of the Standing Committee on | Passed | Yes |
| 42 | 10-28 | — | Third report of the Standing Committee on | Passed | Yes |
| 41 | 10-20 | — | Opposition Motion (Cost of deficits) | Failed | Yes |
| 40 | 10-06 | — | Opposition Motion (Passage of Bill C-242) | Failed | Yes |
| 39 | 10-01 | — | Opposition Motion (Food taxation) | Failed | Yes |
| 38 | 09-24 | — | Opposition Motion (Constitutional powers o | Failed | Yes |
| 37 | 09-23 | — | Opposition Motion (Oil and gas emissions c | Failed | Yes |
| 36 | 09-22 | C-3 | 2nd reading of Bill C-3, An Act to amend t | Passed | No |
| 35 | 09-22 | — | Opposition Motion (Violent crime and repea | Failed | Yes |
| 34 | 06-20 | C-5 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-5, An A | Passed | Yes |
| 33 | 06-20 | C-5 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-5, An A | Passed | Yes |
| 32 | 06-20 | C-5 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-5, A | Passed | Yes |
| 31 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Failed | No |
| 30 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Passed | Yes |
| 29 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Failed | Yes |
| 28 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Failed | No |
| 27 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Passed | Yes |
| 26 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Passed | Yes |
| 25 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Passed | Yes |
| 24 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Failed | Yes |
| 23 | 06-20 | C-5 | Bill C-5, An Act to enact the Free Trade a | Failed | No |
| 22 | 06-17 | C-7 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-7, An A | Passed | No |
| 21 | 06-17 | C-7 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-7, A | Passed | No |
| 20 | 06-17 | C-7 | 2nd reading of Bill C-7, An Act for granti | Passed | No |
| 19 | 06-17 | — | Concurrence in estimates (Supplementary Es | Passed | No |
| 18 | 06-17 | C-6 | 3rd reading and adoption of Bill C-6, An A | Passed | No |
| 17 | 06-17 | C-6 | Concurrence at report stage of Bill C-6, A | Passed | No |
| 16 | 06-17 | C-6 | 2nd reading of Bill C-6, An Act for granti | Passed | No |
| 15 | 06-17 | — | Concurrence in estimates (Main Estimates f | Passed | No |
| 14 | 06-17 | — | Opposition Motion (Sale of gas-powered veh | Failed | Yes |
| 13 | 06-16 | C-5 | 2nd reading of Bill C-5, An Act to enact t | Passed | Yes |
| 12 | 06-16 | — | Government Business No. 1 (Proceedings on | Passed | Yes |

# How Your MP Voted (continued)

| # | DATE | BILL | DESCRIPTION | RESULT | VOTE |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 11 | 06-16 | — | Government Business No. 1 (Proceedings on | Failed | No |
| 10 | 06-16 | — | Opposition Motion (GCStrategies Inc.) | Passed | Yes |
| 9 | 06-16 | — | Motion for closure | Passed | Yes |
| 8 | 06-12 | C-4 | 2nd reading of Bill C-4, An Act respecting | Passed | Yes |
| 7 | 06-11 | — | Opposition Motion (Canada carbon rebate an | Failed | No |
| 6 | 06-11 | — | Opposition Motion (Canada carbon rebate an | Failed | No |
| 5 | 06-10 | — | Opposition Motion (Food inflation and budg | Failed | Yes |
| 4 | 06-05 | — | Ways and means motion No. 1 | Passed | Yes |
| 3 | 06-02 | — | Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th | Passed | Yes |
| 2 | 06-02 | — | Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th | Passed | Yes |
| 1 | 05-29 | — | Address in Reply to the Speech from the Th | Passed | Yes |

Source: OpenParliament.ca · Session 45-1 · All 94 recorded votes

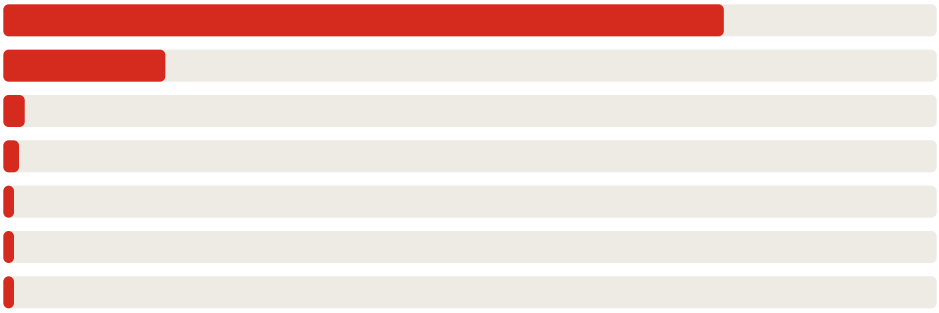
Verify votes on OpenParliament.ca !'

# Federal Spending in Your Riding

## $10.9M total federal investment

Ranked #312 of 340 ridings by per-capita investment | Infrastructure Canada

### Spending by Category



| | |
|---|---|
| Highways and Roads | $8.4M (77%) |
| Wastewater | $1.9M (17%) |
| Ventilation | $0.3M (2%) |
| Active Transportation | $0.2M (2%) |
| Broadband And Connectivity | $0.1M (1%) |
| Capacity Building | $0.1M (0%) |
| Drinking Water | $0.1M (0%) |

### Largest Projects

| PROJECT | FEDERAL $ | CATEGORY |
|---|---|---|
| Pavement Rehabilitation Projects - Southern Alberta (20<br>Recipient: Alberta Ministry of Transportation | $3.5M | Highways and Roads |
| North Industrial Area - Road Work & Storm Water Managem<br>Recipient: Didsbury, Town of | $1.8M | Wastewater |
| Highway 2 Bundle<br>Recipient: Alberta Ministry of Transportation | $1.7M | Highways and Roads |
| County of Ponoka Meniak Road<br>Recipient: Ponoka, County of | $1.5M | Highways and Roads |
| 50 Street Rehabilitation - Town of Ponoka<br>Recipient: Ponoka, Town of | $0.8M | Highways and Roads |
| Resurfacing Highway 2<br>Recipient: Alberta, Government of | $0.5M | Highways and Roads |

+ 4 more projects

Source: Infrastructure Canada Open Data · Open Canada Grants & Contributions

**View Infrastructure Canada project map !'**

# MP Expense Report

Calkins, Blaine · House of Commons Proactive Disclosure

## Current Quarter (Q3 2025-26)

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Staff Salaries** | **$95,553** | 55% of total |
| **Travel** | **$60,002** | 35% of total |
| **Hospitality** | **$1,473** | 1% of total |
| **Contracts** | **$16,048** | 9% of total |

**Q3 Total: $173,076**

Annualized estimate: ~$692,304

Source: House of Commons Proactive Disclosure · ourcommons.ca

**View Q3 2025-26 MP expenses on ourcommons.ca !'**

# How You Compare

National rank:  #220 of 340
Provincial rank (AB):  #17 of 37

## Comparable Ridings

| RIDING | MP | PARTY | GRADE | SCORE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Ponoka—Didsbury** | **Blaine Calkins** | **Conservative** | **D** | **40** |
| Airdrie—Cochrane | Blake Richards | Conservative | D | 40 |
| Calgary Skyview | Amanpreet Gill | Conservative | D | 43 |
| Edmonton Centre | Eleanor Olszewski | Liberal | D | 46 |
| Medicine Hat—Cardston—Warner | Glen Motz | Conservative | D | 46 |
| Red Deer | Burton Bailey | Conservative | D | 47 |

## Questions to Ask Your MP

- What federal infrastructure grants has this riding received in the past 3 years, and how does that compare to similar ridings?
- Voter turnout in this riding was 64.7%. What are you doing to encourage democratic participation?
- This province does not receive equalization payments. How are you ensuring federal investment still flows back to our community?
- What is your top priority for this riding in the next parliamentary session, and how will you measure success?

**MP or staff? Help us improve accuracy.**

If any data in this report is inaccurate, visit bangforyourduck.ca/methodology or email corrections@bangforyourduck.ca with the riding name, the data point in question, and supporting documentation.